

One day, she again challenged me, saying if I really wanted to save money, I should get rid of cable. I admit that I felt palpable fear and anxiety about getting rid of this thing that was an entrenched part of my everyday life. I always had cable, even as a poor college student without two nickels to rub together. I watched *SportsCenter* every morning while working out. The TV was reflexively clicked on when I walked in the door after work. I never missed a big game.

We eventually cut the cord with the plan to get a cheaper web-based entertainment package like Netflix or Hulu. But we never did! We found something unexpected. Life was immeasurably better without this poison in our lives. Instead of watching highlights of games during my morning workout, I started listening to podcasts that enriched my life. Instead of mindlessly turning on the TV after work, my wife and I began having real conversations and became more attentive to our daughter. Instead of falling asleep to a TV show, we began reading books to our daughter. Then we modeled a positive behavior for her by reading our own books until we were ready to go to bed. Watching a “big game” now required me to go spend time with a friend or family member instead of being isolated on my own couch. This made watching the big games more